

Mushroom and Paneer pepper fry

Ingredients

- 760 g button mushrooms
- 400 g paneer (cubed)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 15–20 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 2 tsp freshly crushed black pepper
- 1½ tsp salt (adjust to taste)
- 2 tbsp lemon juice
- 3 tbsp chopped coriander leaves
- 2 green chilies (optional)

Step 1: Prepare

1. Wash mushrooms quickly and pat dry.
2. Cut large mushrooms into halves or quarters.
3. Cut paneer into 1-inch cubes.
4. Finely chop garlic and coriander.

Step 2: Roast the Paneer

1. Heat a large pan.
2. Add 1 tbsp olive oil.
3. Add paneer cubes.
4. Roast for 2–3 minutes on each side until lightly golden.
5. Remove and keep aside.

Step 3: Cook Garlic

1. In the same pan add remaining 1 tbsp olive oil.
2. Add chopped garlic.
3. Stir for 30–40 seconds until fragrant.

Step 4: Cook Mushrooms

1. Add all mushrooms.
2. Keep flame medium-high.
3. Do **not** add water.
4. Stir every 1–2 minutes.
5. Mushrooms will release a lot of water.
6. Continue cooking for **10–15 minutes** until the water evaporates.

Step 5: Brown the Mushrooms

1. After the water dries, keep cooking for another **3–5 minutes**.
2. Let the mushrooms get slightly golden.
3. This is the most important step for flavor.

Step 6: Add Seasoning

1. Add 1½ tsp salt.
2. Add 2 tsp freshly crushed black pepper.
3. Mix well.

Step 7: Add Paneer

1. Add the roasted paneer.
2. Mix gently.
3. Cook for 2–3 minutes.

Step 8: Finish

1. Turn off the heat.
2. Add 2 tbsp lemon juice.
3. Add coriander leaves.
4. Mix and serve immediately.

Extra Taste Tip

If you don't mind a few more ingredients, add:

- 1 medium onion (finely sliced)
- 1 tsp ginger (finely chopped)
- 2 green chilies

Cook the onion after the garlic until light golden, then add mushrooms. This makes the dish significantly tastier while still being healthy and free of sauces or preservatives.